



Speaker 1 - 00:00

It.



Speaker 2 - 00:28

Meditation.



Speaker 1 - 00:36

Hello.



Speaker 2 - 00:37

Hi.



Speaker 1 - 00:38

Hi.



Speaker 2 - 00:38

You were my first. I came here on Tuesday.



Speaker 1 - 00:41

I remember you.



Speaker 2 - 00:42

Good to see you.



Speaker 1 - 00:43

Yeah. Glad you came back. We had a glowing reviews from these folks who said to come to meditation and you did.

And. Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 00:57

I dim the lights is out there or no. Should we have full fledged?



Speaker 1 - 01:01

No, they're not dimmed when I'm doing. Oh, they're fine for me sometimes. The ambiance.



Speaker 2 - 01:29

How'd you like that yoga you did come for? Oh, yoga I liked. You didn't come for the other one.



Speaker 1 - 01:48

Oh, yeah.



Speaker 2 - 01:50

You could do that too. Yeah. But yeah, I think he comes back on Sunday.



Speaker 1 - 01:55

Okay.



Speaker 2 - 01:57

I think he's Monday, Friday, Sunday.



Speaker 1 - 01:59

Okay. So.



Speaker 2 - 02:00

Or maybe you I'm thinking is coming on Sunday. I'm sorry, Andy.



Speaker 1 - 02:07

Yeah, I'm sorry. That's right. Sunday.



Speaker 2 - 02:08

You come on Sunday.



Speaker 1 - 02:09

Sunday. Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 02:10

I knew.



Speaker 1 - 02:11

Yeah. Nine in the morning. Yeah. Early in Sunday. That's nice. Yeah. Yeah. I switch.



Speaker 3 - 02:23

I have you guys first on Sundays and I go down the canyon after that.



Speaker 2 - 02:31

Yeah. So we decorated the tree and Teo was supposed to do this side. That's why it's empty. Looks very cle.



Speaker 1 - 02:39

You could rotate it. I know.



Speaker 2 - 02:42

I've got that too. Logical. There's a bunch of people coming.



Speaker 4 - 02:52

I don't know if they're all coming in here. I think I saw JP looking. But you can't see anything here outside. I wonder if she's left.



Speaker 1 - 03:02

Can't see anything. Hello. Oh, look at you, Mr. Happy. And I didn't even do that much. That's how bad my left body.



Speaker 2 - 03:27

No, but that's good. That's going to keep doing it. That's right.



Speaker 5 - 03:30

Oh, gosh.



Speaker 2 - 03:33

When I first did it, I looked like a sagging bridge all the time. But then he's like, you know, sucking your butt or push your butt in so that you're more flatter.



Speaker 1 - 03:44

Yeah. Hey, how you doing?



Speaker 2 - 03:48

Hey, Andy.



Speaker 1 - 03:48

I forgot my binder, so can you sign my thing later or something? Five bucks.



Speaker 2 - 03:54

Five dollars.



Speaker 1 - 03:55

I'm playing with them. I saw his eyes light up. What?



Speaker 2 - 04:01

I just want to apologize before this meditation starts. I've been having a lot of hiccup episodes. So if I start hiccuping in the middle of it and it's disruptive, I will probably just excuse myself. But that's all.



Speaker 1 - 04:16

That's okay.



Speaker 2 - 04:18

I don't want to be doing that though. Hey, look, Thomas. You coming for meditation.



Speaker 5 - 04:28

Thomas?



Speaker 1 - 04:35

Go for it, Peter. Oh, yeah. Just a little bit.



Speaker 2 - 04:48

You can sit on that side.



Speaker 1 - 04:49

I'm recovery center Life. Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 05:13

This is where they resort my.



Speaker 1 - 05:17

Yeah, it's all a resort when you're not dealing with your problems directly. So. Yeah. Okay. Well. Wow. This is a. A good group. I've had a couple Fridays here. Where was. Well, I had one with zero and then I had one with one. I was happy with one. I enjoy it. Doesn't matter in the number of people, but I'm glad you guys are all here. So you're new?



Speaker 2 - 05:49

I'm Z.



Speaker 1 - 05:50

You're Z. Hi, Z. I'm A. Andy. A to Z. And I met. I met. What's your name? Marcella. Met Marcella. Last time was me and Thomas. We had a wonderful affair while you guys are out enjoying the moonlight walk. So for the benefit of Z. And I'm going to kind of go to the beginning and give her a little bit of an intro. If you guys want, you can either meditate and just take in the words and. Or you can just wait till I formally start the meditation.



Speaker 3 - 06:40

Okay.



Speaker 1 - 06:41

So what I kind of like to do is try and draw some interest. Why would you be interested in meditation? So why you'd be interested in meditation is because you're in recovery and you're here at a recovery center and you're trying to not drink and use and stop sabotaging your life. Right? So that's kind of. So this idea of you come here with an interest, a vested interest in your own welfare and a vested interest in changing the direction the tendency is why you're here. Right. So this is great for meditation. This is exactly the same mindset that you want to have. And you're new to here, so I'm just giving an overview of. Why would you meditate? What's your interest? Because guess what?



Speaker 1 - 07:51

When you close your eyes and you meditate, then the mirror of your mind is going to tell you, show you everything that's going on. And so you need to have courage to face it. So this mindfulness practice that we talk about, that I'm going to talk to you about is basically recognizing what's going on, you know, where that's happening and allowing. So it's this recognition and allowing and then watching. So what do you recognize? You recognize how you don't want to meditate, that you're struggling, you fighting the meditation, you're disinterested in the meditation. You'd rather be go talk smoking a cigarette and talking to people than being in here meditating, or you'd rather go to bed and sleep. Sleep or anything else other than facing yourself. But this gift of Getting to know yourself, right, Is a.



Speaker 1 - 08:58

I think there's a one teacher that talks about. It's the jewel, the gold mine that you're sitting on that's here all the time that you look, that you avoid because you're looking elsewhere, you're looking for somewhere else. You're looking for somebody to make you feel whole or something to make you feel whole or somebody to distract you from yourself, right? This is what we're trying to do. We're interested in the world, we want it. We're interested in the pleasure of the life, right? We're not interested in our fears and our worries and our self judgment. But in order for us to be happy, joyous and free, we have to face that. So I'm going to encourage you and I'm going to challenge you. Have courage. Have courage, okay? Because guess what? You're none of those things you're worried about.



Speaker 1 - 09:55

They're just thoughts, they're just feelings, they're just emotions. They're not even personal. I can bring a word to mind. I can say the word angry and feel how anger feels in your body. It doesn't feel good. If I say I'm upset with you feel that. You internalize it, right? But if I say I love you, I kill for you, that brings peace and comfort. You want to hear that. You want love from the rest of the world. You want to love yourself. This is about loving and caring for ourselves deeply, not superficially. And we're so afraid of the boogeyman that is ourself. So have courage to look at yourself and accept what you see. So that's the first you see the interest. I'm trying to get you here. This is the motivation. Your freedom is at stake now, so that's important.



Speaker 1 - 11:09

So that your freedom is at stake, so you have an interest. So mindfulness is basically this idea of paying attention to yourself and the way you deal with the world and look at the world. So what that means is watching what your mind does. So are you interested right now? I know you're listening to me now. I'm just going to go do a little test with you. Here you can also be listening to me, but here hearing just my voice. Pay attention just to my voice, not to what I'm saying. Listen just to my voice. The sound. You could pay attention to the sound and not be connected with the content. You're still hearing the content, but it's the focus I'm talking about. You're aware of the sound, just like you can be Aware of sight, seeing things.



Speaker 1 - 12:09

You can be aware of feelings, touch, you can be aware of thinking. You're aware you're thinking when you're thinking. So that. Guess what? If you're aware you're thinking, then you're not the thinking. What? Right? How could you be the thinking and know the thinking at the same time? Let's keep going with that. How could you be the emotion and know that there's an emotion? How can you be the feeling and know that there's a feeling? Right? So this knowing quality is what the suggestion is this uncolored, untainted awareness of what's going on. That's what we want to connect you to. So all the rest of this stuff that's going on in the world is noise. So you want to learn to be with the noise, to recognize the noise and let go of the noise.



Speaker 1 - 13:16

You don't have to push it away because that creates more noise. You're not here trying to make anything happen, you're allowing it to happen. It's grace. This is a hard lesson and it's going to come up over and over because we easily get caught. Easily get caught, right? We easily get caught. So don't try not to put yourself down. If you do, be aware that you're putting yourself down. Right? So this awareness, this knowing quality, connect with it as best you can. Accept what you see. And then once things start settling down, then you're building resources, you enjoy a little bit of peace, right? Enjoy that peace. And then all of a sudden it has its own momentum on its own. You generate energy in what you're doing. You're more focused and absorbed into what you're doing.



Speaker 1 - 14:20

It becomes something that you can use to refill your bank of energy and fill yourself up. It's like going to a hot tub or

a spa. You want to re energize, but you can do that with your own mind too. That's what meditation is all about. There's a lot of possibilities, no guarantees, but this is the practice. So have faith, regardless of how difficult it can be at times. You're going to have your good days and you're going to have your bad days. You're going to have your good moments and you're going to have your bad moments. You're going to have good thoughts and you're going to have bad thoughts. We're the anchor. Your awareness is your anchor, right? So if you turn your attention to this awareness, then it will give you a protection from all these storms that are coming.



Speaker 1 - 15:16

We're all going to have lots of storms coming. Old age, sickness and death is coming for us all and everybody we know, everybody we love and care about. There's nothing in this world we can take with us. We have to leave it all behind. So this is us facing that fact and getting real and connecting with what is real with us getting to know and loves this person. So we're not going to meditate. Now that I've set it down so you're interested now, you're going to stay alert to this. Stay alert. Be aware. Be aware of what's going on. Mindful mindfulness means remembering. You don't have to write, you have just remembering what's going on, right? So when you forget, a thought comes, oh, you might get drawn into the story, whatever.



Speaker 1 - 16:16

Then all of a sudden you're going to say, oh, that's right, we're all here meditating together. I'm supposed to be following my breath, then bow to the story. Thank you. I'm going to meditate now and come back to your breathing. It's puppy on the paper, puppy on the paper. Okay, so that's what we're doing here. Okay. Be gentle with yourself and just aware. Okay, Any questions from anybody? So as far as formal meditation, you can sit in a chair. You could be lying down, you could be walking, you could be standing. But for most meditations, people are sitting. Be as comfortable as possible. You want to be alert, so you don't want to be in a position where you're going to go to sleep.



Speaker 3 - 17:01

You want to be relaxed and alert.



Speaker 1 - 17:06

So when you've got your body in position, you're naturally putting mindfulness right in front of you. You see how you naturally did that.



Speaker 3 - 17:13

You know how to do that. So bring your awareness into your body. And to start out, we're just being aware of any kind of sensation. So be aware of the floor, on your feet, pressure. Be aware of your butt on the cushion, pressure on your back. You might feel tension in the shoulders or in the neck. Rotate your shoulders, if you have any, allow it to go. Be aware of any kind of tension in the eyes or in the forehead, back of the neck. And then just resting your awareness in the body. This natural breath energy that comes to breathing, that comes to the forefront.



Speaker 3 - 18:33

Being aware of your breath and your breathing might feel it in the diaphragm or in the chest is the lungs filling, contracting, or at the tip of the nose is cool air coming in, warm air going out wherever it's Most comfortable for you. This is your home base. Being aware of the rhythm of the breathing in and out. I become aware of the quality of your breathing. Are you relaxed breathing? Is it tight, is it deep or is it shallow? Fast or slow? You don't have to figure it out. You're just this knowing. Quality of what is this? First few minutes can be a little agitating. Just allow for this awareness to settle in the body. If your mind is a little active in the beginning, you can also count one breath, two, count up to 10, come back down to one, repeat.





Speaker 3 - 21:13

And then when you settle down, maybe just letting go of the counting. Be aware of sounds, aware of my voice as a sound or that fan ticking. This is what hearing is like. Might be aware of feelings, tingling in the body or little pains that come floating through. Just awareness. Allow them to come and go. Resting into the breathing. Aware of your mind. Our mind states are always changing. Keeping this in your attention, this knowing.



Speaker 1 - 23:29

It's.



Speaker 3 - 33:09

Questions. Any feedback? Feedback, sure.



Speaker 2 - 33:18

Okay, so I used to do practice, I tried a long time ago practicing meditation over and over again and then like the intrusive thoughts and whatever. So I've actually been really working on it since like the whole co thing.



Speaker 1 - 33:37

Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 33:38

Cuz I'm at home and I'm doing what I learned, which has actually really helped me is when like the thoughts start to come in. I just say like I see you thought and I see you leaving and I just like watch the thought go. But like that is so good. I'm so happy. The only problem is that when I opened my eyes I forgot where I was.



Speaker 1 - 34:03

And then I was like, that's okay.



Speaker 2 - 34:07

I mean I'm happy, I'm happy, happy that I'm here. But I was like ready to open my eyes and see my baby. But it was very good and very soothing.



Speaker 1 - 34:20

Yeah, that's another level of awareness. Remember, you know, so you forgot where you were. You know, so you know that's. And that's okay. You, you know, that's something you can remember. You know, one thing that you said and just want to. Just want to emphasize. And I believe this to be very important. Whatever comes in your mind, you're not here to force yourself to not think. You're not here to force yourself to be anything other than to recognize what is. So if you're disturbed, try turning to your awareness of a couple of things you can aware that you're disturbed. You could focus on the fact that you're disturbed or you could Be focused on the fact that you're aware that you're thinking so different. There's different levels of our awareness or regardless of what's going on, recognizing just coming in to some anchor.



Speaker 1 - 35:30

For instance, for me, I have a spot in my mind that I go to that's actually where my breathing is and everything is. And I just connect with that. So I use whatever I'm experiencing to fuel my focus and awareness on that area. So, for instance, where this is helpful is I get a lot of pain on the long sits for long retreats and things like that. So I could put my mind there. And all of a sudden I'm meditating for like an hour and a half and I'm not aware, you know, because I'm not putting my interest and energy on the pain. I'm putting my interest on what. On what feels good. So you can see I'm saying is you could feed the pain or you can feed the good, so you could turn away from the pain. Right.



Speaker 1 - 36:28

So this is where you practice and you practice by having pleasure and pain and being aware of how you deal with it. So whatever comes up, that's what you're teaching what your teacher for today is. Right. Just. So this accepting thing. Okay, so this is. It's a different quality. Like you're in school, learning your date. I like to call it data collection. You're collecting data. You don't have to do anything. What happens to us, our freedom is grace. I believe it's grace. Right. There's some intuitive grace that happens in this that our greater wisdom says you don't have to say suffer anymore. Let go. Right. And then you let go. And that doesn't mean you don't love your kids or you don't love. Care about your life. It has nothing to do with that. Right.



Speaker 1 - 37:26

That's another thought that you can get connected to and get attached to. Right. So it's watching these ways that we attach to ideas and concepts and beliefs about who we are, what the way we should be. I should be a good meditator. I want to be the best meditator in this group tonight.



Speaker 2 - 37:47

Are there any exactly what you're explaining right now.



Speaker 1 - 37:51

Sure.



Speaker 2 - 37:52

That you like out after group that you could maybe give me.



Speaker 1 - 37:57

Yeah. I mean there's quite a few. It's practice of mindfulness. And in my tradition, what I follow.



Speaker 2 - 38:04

Yeah, your.



Speaker 1 - 38:05

Well, my tradition. Yeah, it's a form of Buddhism and yeah. It's. They give free. Free books. You don't have to buy a dang Thing, you know, you don't have to go. And I buy a lot of books anyway because of my interest in it. But yeah, you know, there's. There's free resources out there. Did I turn you on emoji last time?



Speaker 4 - 38:25

Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 38:26

Did you see it?



Speaker 4 - 38:27

I had to reorder my earphones because.



Speaker 1 - 38:29

I. Oh, so you did. There's a lot of great teachers out there, so free stuff. You don't have to have a book about it. Another thing I want to caution you on, it's not education. Your thinking is not going to get you out of this. I just want to be aware. Oh, right.



Speaker 4 - 38:53

Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 38:55

I want to know more. And I know that you're here for very long, but like, just like the way that you're talking about, like, setting your intention.



Speaker 1 - 39:03

Oh, yeah.



Speaker 2 - 39:04

And like all of that stuff. Yeah, that's really interesting. And I'd like to learn more.



Speaker 1 - 39:08

Yeah, you're motivated. You're motivated, then you're. When you're motivated, you're going to take an interest in what you're. You're doing. If you're not motivated, then you're. It's going to go in one ear and out the other. Right. So what motivates us? Pain motivates us. Suffering motivates us. Right. Now, some people can think of meditation, mindfulness meditation as I can be more concentrated at my job or I can be a better employee, or I can, you know, whatever, you know, I'm saying you could. There's different ways you can apply this stuff. Some of them are very. I mean, these are good things. So being a good employee is a good thing. Being more peaceful is a good thing. There's a lot of good things that we can focus on, but those aren't the primary things. This awakening to our freedom is really the crown jewel.



Speaker 2 - 40:11

I want to understand what you're saying. It's kind of like a different language to me right now.



Speaker 1 - 40:15

Yeah, it is a different language. Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 40:17

Interesting. I'm feeling it.



Speaker 1 - 40:21

Great. That's great. Guy named Tana Surabhiku. I can write his name down for you. Endless, endless teachings. He

has. He has 15 minute, 10 to 15 minute talks that he does every single day that he posts on his website. They're free, all of the materials. He's one of the most prolific writers about Buddhist practice. Practice. All his material is free and easily available.



Speaker 2 - 40:49

I wonder if that aligns with. We did the Dharma.



Speaker 1 - 40:53

That's it. Dharma, Recovery. I know that.



Speaker 2 - 40:55

Yeah, that's the speaker that were hearing.



Speaker 1 - 40:58

Yeah. Recovery. Dharma is a Perfect recovery. Dharma is a group that brings the Buddhist teachings into a kind of like a 12 step environment.



Speaker 2 - 41:08

Right. Okay, cool.



Speaker 1 - 41:09

Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 41:09

I was wondering, because last night were watching this thing and I'm like, I don't know what's going on, but I. I'm. It's really interesting. And so, yeah, I will write that name down for me and I'll stop talking.



Speaker 1 - 41:20

Okay, that's right. How was that for you, sir?



Speaker 5 - 41:24

Good.



Speaker 1 - 41:25

Yeah.



Speaker 5 - 41:26

Similar experience.



Speaker 1 - 41:27

I was.



Speaker 5 - 41:28

Got lost thinking for a moment. I caught myself multiple times. And then once I got caught just kind of in my mind, I kind of like reached for the water bottle on a table and opened my eyes.



Speaker 1 - 41:46

And I was like, oh, okay. Yeah. So that's brought myself back, closed my.



Speaker 5 - 41:54

Eyes and just kept trying to catch myself and just bring it back.



Speaker 1 - 41:59

I just want to caution you. You don't have to catch yourself. So when I'm trying to reinforce here. Yeah. It's as if you can just ask yourself, what's going on? What's going on? Like right now when I ask you what's going on is that you're listening to me, Right? That's pretty darn obvious. Right? That's what you're doing. You're listening to me. So you can ask yourself, so what's going on? What's going on? Right. And then that means that you're tuned in by asking that question to what's going on. There's another method that they teach a teacher by the name of Tara Brock Herring, Jack Kornfield are kind of the foremost Western teachers. And she teaches a thing called rain, which is when dealing with. When you're having difficult times. So this practice rain is easy to remember. Right. Rain. Okay.



Speaker 1 - 42:59

So it's recognize, accept, investigate, and nurture. And I can explain what those things are. And I already have, actually. Everything we've done tonight is related to them. So wait to get your. So the R is recognize. So that's back to the question I asked you. What's going on? Right. Knowing what's going on. Right. So accept. Accept is critical. So this is this receptive awareness of what's going on. So those first two steps of recognizing and accepting is the practice of mindfulness. Okay. Those are the first. Those are the foundational steps. Investigation is a part of this

path also. So investigate means not to go into the story and into the belief and into the concept and try to sort it out and figure it out. That's not what you're doing. You're basically asking yourself, what am I doing?



Speaker 1 - 44:17

Am I causing myself more stress or am I alleviating my stress? This path is all about stress and the ending of stress. Okay. Stuffing and end suffering, for example, in.



Speaker 5 - 44:33

That book for, I guess is the practice of a awareness. I almost felt as if I. I got so in such a kind of a dream in the mind where I, you know, was in a different.



Speaker 1 - 44:59

Yes, right.



Speaker 5 - 44:59

So see, it's the full, the aware and grounded that I am here and let those thoughts sort of happen.



Speaker 1 - 45:12

Yes. So this is the crux of it. I'm giving the shortcut. Everything that we experience is conditioned. And it's. None of it's us. Okay? So what I mean by that is that everything has some cause and condition and has its own life based on that. Everything is impermanent. Nothing is permanent, so it's always changing. It's impermanent and it's a source of suffering. And the reason why it's a source of suffering is because we cling to it. So that's the foundations for this practice. But everything is conditioned. So when I point you to this knowing quality, that knowing quality is not conditioned. It's not tainted by emotions, it's not tainted by feelings. Right. So, you know, I'm going to use a word here. Don't be scared about it. It's called the deathless, the unconditioned, the unfabricated. Right. So these are words they use for it.



Speaker 1 - 46:29

Right. So when you allow even beautiful states of meditation, great meditative attainments, you could feel like a million bucks. They're all conditioned. They're all going to stop and go away because they're caused. They're all conditioned though. Right? Right. So what happens is we put a lot of our faith on stuff that we can't control that's impermanent, that the causes. I'm going to say the same thing over. We put our faith into our thinking. We identify with our thinking. We identify with our feelings. We identify with our stories. The only reason why we identify with our stories is because we keep on having the memories and identifying with them. If we would just let go of the stories. All we have is now. All we have is here and now.



Speaker 1 - 47:26

And we can't enjoy the here and now because we're worried about the past and future. How is it going to be in the future? How is it going to be in the future? How is it going to be in the future? Forgetting we're living our future right now.



Speaker 2 - 47:42

So basically, mindfulness is checking in with where I am right now, here, right now. And then Meditation would be some things.



Speaker 1 - 47:52

So there's no. So there's a. There's multiple things. There's. It's a process, right? So mindfulness has to be the base, right? So if you're not mindful, then nothing else happens, right? So the idea is that you're mindful. Well, I'll. I'll give you actually the part. There's three other parts to it. So it's basically your behavior, what they call samsara. Okay? So if you're lying, cheating and stealing, don't inspect. Be peaceful. You're fooling yourself. So you have to have some kind of morals, personal morals, not me putting them on your own morals. Remember I was saying you have to learn to love yourself. You don't love yourself if you're lying and cheating and stealing. There's no way that you could love yourself if you did that to people, right? If you do feel that way, then there's a certain thinking in there that's not right.



Speaker 1 - 48:53

Okay. Distorted, right? That's right. And what we're trying to do is look at those distortions. Those distortions are normal. Most of us are not awake, right? And so we want to be able to awaken ourselves by allowing things to settle down. So back there's the sila practice and there's the samadhi practice is what this meditation is. Mindfulness is part of the samadhi practice, okay? However, mindfulness is actually something we can use in every moment all the time. So it's something that we use all the time. And you can. It can grow by you paying attention to it. It's also conditional. So this mindfulness is. Awareness actually fosters some other things. There's these seven factors they talk about. So there's mindfulness has to be there all the time. Then there's investigation, right? So we investigate what's going on.



Speaker 1 - 49:54

This is where we're learning how to stay with our breath, how not to be distracted, you know, how to be peaceful. So you're learning. So that's by you paying attention and practicing, right? So boom, boom. You can't practice if you don't try. You don't get on the bicycle, you don't do anything, right? You're not going to learn anything. You can think about it, but thinking about it's not going to get you anywhere. That's why I was cautioning you about education. So then that energy, well, then that creates energy. So then you see, you're building momentum, and then you end up having concentration. Concentration brings a lot of tranquility and peace. And then there's what they call equanimity and equanimity, basically, where everything is just. You're not making any waves in the world, right? You're not making any ripples, you're not causing anything, right?



Speaker 1 - 50:49

You're present. This is pure presence. I'll call it pure presence. And then basically from there, what you're trying to do is get to that point for things to settle. Because guess what happens when there's this pure presence, this stillness, every movement of the mind causes a ripple. So then everything that you do causes a ripple and brings you to being, caused suffering. So then, you see, it keeps on refining itself. So this is the path now. That's it. This is the path. And what ends up happening is that you're just collecting. You're not going to just be mindful. And that's it. There's a lot of other things you do. For instance, like I said, you have to behave properly. You have to keep on refining this, whatever.



Speaker 1 - 51:45

But if you keep on drinking and using, if you keep on lying, cheating and stealing, you're going the other direction. So



we want to get you. So guess what? This is a path, a spiritual path. It could be a part of any spiritual path. Meaning you could use this by itself. You could be a person that likes to walk in nature with trees and use this path. Path. Or you could be a Catholic bishop. You could be whatever you want. There's no limitations. This practice is an augment to anything that you do want to do. And so that's why I believe in it, and that's why I want to get it to you. And I also call it the knife. As you can tell, this is a knife to everything, right?



Speaker 1 - 52:30

If you can get this to practice down and use this as your refuge. This is why I like to use that word, right? This is your protection. Then when your disease says you're a piece of shit, you're going to say, no, you said earlier, mara, I'm not a piece of shit. I'm not going to listen to that stupid thought. That's an old thought that I beat down forever. You know what I'm saying? Your knowledge and wisdom is going to say, I'm not going to listen to you, right? You see, I'm saying, so this is the kind of wisdom we're trying to. You're knowing how we cause our own suffering. How do we. How do we cause our own suffering? Because we listen to that kind of stuff. We act on that. We get disturbed. If you know not to even listen to that.



Speaker 1 - 53:20

It won't disturb you. Right. If you have some hint of. That's kind of identifying. That's why I like to use word identifying. Am I running out of time? Okay, I got four minutes, so I'll wrap this up quickly. Okay. I get excited about this and I in.



Speaker 2 - 53:38

And you're making me excited about it.



Speaker 1 - 53:40

That's good. And that's what you know. And I just want. I. I don't want, you know, I want. That's. I want to pique your interest because this is a total. This is something, your personal practice that you can make your own, that nobody can touch. People won't even understand it. This is not the way the rest of the world operates. Right. Go ahead.



Speaker 5 - 54:02

Another quick question, I guess with regards to my experience just now initially doing that, I did have kind of different things come up, but I was aware of that and be aware.



Speaker 1 - 54:15

Awareness. Great.



Speaker 5 - 54:18

Thank you.

Speaker 1 - 54:19



Right. Bow to it. Yep. Yeah.



Speaker 5 - 54:24

And then. And then the next one, I sort of lost the awareness.



Speaker 1 - 54:29

Yep.



Speaker 5 - 54:29

That's when I kind of got there. But is that what we're after is.



Speaker 1 - 54:32

Simply just the knowing quality, the awareness knowing when you don't. When you get caught. When you don't get caught. Not only that, it goes even deeper. So how do you stay there? Once you get peaceful, then you have to figure out, okay, how do I stay here and how do I deepen this? Because guess what's going to happen? You're going to be in this peaceful thing. Then you're going to think about cheesecake or whatever. And then all of a sudden you're not being up. See, I triggered somebody right there. So then what ends up happening Right then all of a sudden you're all this peaceful state and some innocent little thought came up and you're down the rabbit hole of I'm a piece of crap because I'm not, you know. You know what I'm saying? And you forgot about the cheesecake.



Speaker 1 - 55:16

It was just a thought about cheesecake. Right. That's how simple puffy on the paper. No. No separation. I mean, you don't. Just awareness. Yeah. So basically, yeah. Just following the breath and noticing what takes you off the breath, basically, if it's for to get it easy as I can get it, is that paying attention to your breathing and noticing what knocks you off, because that breathing brings you to some of the highest states you've ever heard, felt, ever. You know what I mean? And can take you to the end. You can get attached to that too. So there's A caution there. You can get attached to high meditations, but that's not it either. That's conditional. That's why I mentioned it's conditional. So this teaching has. You're not to follow conditions.



Speaker 1 - 56:15

If you do, then you're setting yourself up for suffering because you can't hold on to them. They're not lasting. They're not real even. They're just hearing God, hearing gone here and gone. So learning to understand that and know that for yourself is how the practice deepens. Okay, well, I talked a lot more and ran into it a lot longer tonight than I thought, but thank you, guys. Great. Oh, man. I'll get you next time.



Speaker 2 - 56:54

And then if you could write down the name of that person.



Speaker 1 - 56:57

Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 57:00

You can finish everything.



Speaker 1 - 57:01

Yeah, hold on a second. I'll just write his name down.



Speaker 2 - 57:10

Yeah, I would have spelled that wrong.



Speaker 1 - 57:13

That's right. That's right. But it's a mm. Talks.org and when you go on there, they've got books and talks, so. Yeah. Yeah. Nice to meet you. I'll see you on Sunday and Tuesdays and Fridays. Thank you. You're welcome to do this. Oh, man.



Speaker 2 - 57:48

Next time.



Speaker 1 - 57:49

Yeah, next time. So 12 4R. And then I think the 11 was 11 12. Tuesday, 12, 1. There you go.



Speaker 2 - 58:04

Thank you so much.



Speaker 1 - 58:04

Don't tell him I gave it to you for free, cuz I'm trying to charge him the thing.



Speaker 2 - 58:07

Oh, yeah.



Speaker 1 - 58:10

Hi, sir. How you doing, man?



Speaker 4 - 58:18

Doing good. This morning or afternoon. I got kind of irritated, so I wasn't. I wasn't feeling so good.



Speaker 1 - 58:29

But it's okay if I tell you what's happened to me from my retreat? It's okay the way it is, man.



Speaker 4 - 58:39

Yeah. I just waited it out because I know it's temporary.



Speaker 1 - 58:42

Oh, there you go. See, that's smart. That's smart. That's great. I got a lot of anger in me right now. I snapped on my wife yesterday and. And people. It's like, what's going on with me? Right?



Speaker 4 - 59:01

Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 59:02

Nice.



Speaker 4 - 59:04

Like you said, temporary. So trying to stay quiet and not say too much to anybody and wait it out.



Speaker 1 - 59:11

Yeah. Did it change after?



Speaker 4 - 59:13

I took a nap after lunch, I felt a little better and then talked to my therapist and felt better after that. Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 59:22

That's great. See, at least you felt it. You went through it and you were trying to deal with it. See, that's the right attitude to have. Sometimes you just have to accept it. Right. And try not to harm anybody. Blah, blah. That's great.



Speaker 4 - 59:38

I'm irritated to warm them.



Speaker 1 - 59:41

Yeah, no, I do that all the time. Yeah, That's a good thing. Yeah. So, great. Good job.



Speaker 4 - 59:46

A little better than what I used to do.



Speaker 1 - 59:48

Oh, man. I'm gonna have you teaching me what you're doing. Alrighty.



Speaker 4 - 59:52

Thank you so much.



Speaker 1 - 59:53

You're welcome. You have a good night, you guys.



Speaker 2 - 59:56

Yeah, that's cool.



Speaker 1 - 59:58

Oh, sorry. Oh, no problem. All right. Yeah, good night.



Speaker 2 - 01:00:14

But then. But then the thought comes in and then what I acknowledge.